

Video Submission: Initial Session Reflection

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Author Note

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I have no known conflict of interest to disclose.

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Skills

I started this first session with the new counselor by building rapport .23 seconds in. I asked about him and his day and allowed him to share his needs and concerns. For a few minutes, I practiced supportive listening. At 2:14 in the session, I shifted to using immediacy and transference/countertransference to help the counselor adjust to ambivalence. As we started watching the video of his session, I pointed out strengths (6:24, 20:20, 25:22, 33:00) the counselor has in question asking, non-verbal safety, and alliance with the client. As the counselor had expressed anxiety over his second-ever session, I used validation of anxiety at 6:30 and 35:45 to decrease his anxiety and encourage his abilities. Allowing the counselor to express his conceptualization without suggesting other solutions (9:00) allowed him to grow in verbalizing conceptualization among colleagues and to hear himself process. I heard a similar pattern to the counselor's story in the presentation set-up of this video, so I began teaching awareness of countertransference at 10:54 in hopes of building the counselor's ability to stay present in a session when this happens. Having been explicitly asked how to do so and seeing an opportunity to deepen this session we were watching, I taught appropriate skills to deepen the session at 12:20. Soon after, at 13:20, I validated the counselor's presence in session and noticed his non-verbal cues were appropriate for the session. I hoped to build his confidence by allowing the counselor to evaluate his own session, point out his skills, and point out how he was in the session at 17:00. Processing the process at 17:30; we shifted to a view of the person of the counselor in hopes of discovering his ability to be aware of himself in session and reminding him that he is human in session and not just completing some tasks. Other skills I utilized were teaching good presence with the client at 19:50. 25:36, 29:30, teaching difference in questions

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for assessment and questions for curiosity and deepening, 26:13 teaching reflecting emotion through intuition. I then used role-play with reflection at 27:10 so the counselor could get a feel for new ways to help clients become aware of themselves. I also used interpersonal skills of non-verbals of good skills reflection (nodding, smiling, paralinguistics, and eye contact) at 27:45. At 31:30 I was modeling emotional deepening in continuation of the previous topic of concern with the client. The interaction at 32:45 was teaching alliance building. As a former and current high school teacher, I wanted the counselor to see the difference between teaching and counseling (34:00). Wrapping up the session, I was teaching awareness of self (35:00), teaching how to conceptualize treatment (42:20), and (43:47) trying to help counselor find his own answers.

Improvements

To improve this session I would like to have had more specific goals to work through. This would allow me to keep track of the conversation and teaching elements throughout. I would also have liked to set up the video better (6:00) by having the counselor tell me the age, gender, session count, and presenting issue before watching the video. In the future, I will focus more on the skills of the counselor and less on theory. If the theory does come up, I will focus more on allowing the counselor to present the theory (40:20).

One other improvement to note is that I noticed that I was overly concerned about my own video recording. I embarrassingly noted it to the counselor as well. I can improve our sessions by focusing on something other than my video (21:00). I also need to slow down on theory. He is a practicum student, and I need to remember that building skills and focusing on one theory or intervention at a time will help him improve. I want to suggest (or have him suggest) one intervention to practice in this next session.

Overall, this was a successful supervision I am content with.